

World War II meat shortages, and the Harvard cognoscenti, always alert for new taste thrills, found it gamier and more interesting than plain old cow steak, especially when washed down with an amusing little Australian Pinot Chardonnay. So it stays on the menu, a permanent fixture. Horse steak is the symbol of the open, questing mind, which is how Harvard likes to think of itself.

Anyway, Dr. McArthur is slicing his way through his own horse steak, modestly pointing out that his samples are too small to be sure. That means if he published this as a scholarly paper with a colon in the middle of the title, the academic psychologists and social scientists might jump all over him. They would probably jump all over him anyway for the very idea of searching for anything so sordid as the type of personality that makes money. Money is anathema in the groves of Academe unless it comes from foundations or the Government, especially the Government.

One thing Dr. McArthur's probings outline is that there is a personality difference between the people who are good at finding stocks and the people who call the shots on the timing and manage the whole portfolio. Security analysts dog down information and come up with an idea about what should be bought or sold, but they do not necessarily make good conductors for the whole orchestra. If they are woodwind players to start, they tend to hear the whole orchestra as woodwinds, and it takes another type to keep the woodwinds and brasses and strings in line.

How is a good security analyst spotted? The first thing the testers give you — and the potential conductor too — is a Strong test, named after the Stanford psychologist who devised it. Somewhere along the line you have already taken a vocational preference test, so this one will be familiar to you. It is designed to tell you what you like, just in case you have been conning yourself. The questions are multiple choice, like this:

Tomorrow is a holiday, and you can do anything you want. Would you rather